Foreword

THIS BOOK IS NOT A history of the development of Indian banking during the last century, nor is it a collection of biographical profiles of the six personalities who figure prominently in it. However, in a sense it is a bit of both. The author offers us glimpses of Indian banking history intertwined expertly with the pioneering contributions of six eminent personalities whose stellar contributions transcended the boundaries of individual institutions and influenced the banking industry as a whole.

When the trustees of The A.D. Shroff Memorial Trust invited Bakhtiar K. Dadabhoy to author this book they had two objectives in mind. First, to identify and narrate some of the seminal events and episodes which shaped the course of Indian banking; and second, to recognise and highlight the contributions of six illustrious individuals who made a crucial difference. Bakhtiar has accomplished this task admirably. A book such as this with its emphasis on facts could easily have become a dreary catalogue of dry statistics and facts but the author enlivens his narrative with colourful details and interesting anecdotes, and deserves to be congratulated for his diligent and resourceful research. This book, focusing as it does on the history of five institutions whose importance is indisputable, provides a broad-brush tapestry of some of the seminal events and institutions which shaped Indian banking. Delicately woven into this fabric are the contributions of six illustrious individuals whose contribution to Indian banking was immense.